

HRRP BULLETIN

7 January 2019



Urusha Shakya (left) and Shikshya Shrestha (right), Civil engineer, CPLIU, NRA inspecting Hollow Concrete Block houses in Manakamana VDC, Nuwakot. Urusha is the 'featured technical staff person' in this edition of the bulletin and shares her experience working as an inspection engineer in Kalyanpur VDC, Nuwakot, then as focal person for inspection engineers in Nuwakot, and since September 2018 working in Kathmandu Building DLPIU where she verifies inspection files submitted by inspection engineers and is focused on Dakshinkali and Kirtipur Municipality.

Highlights

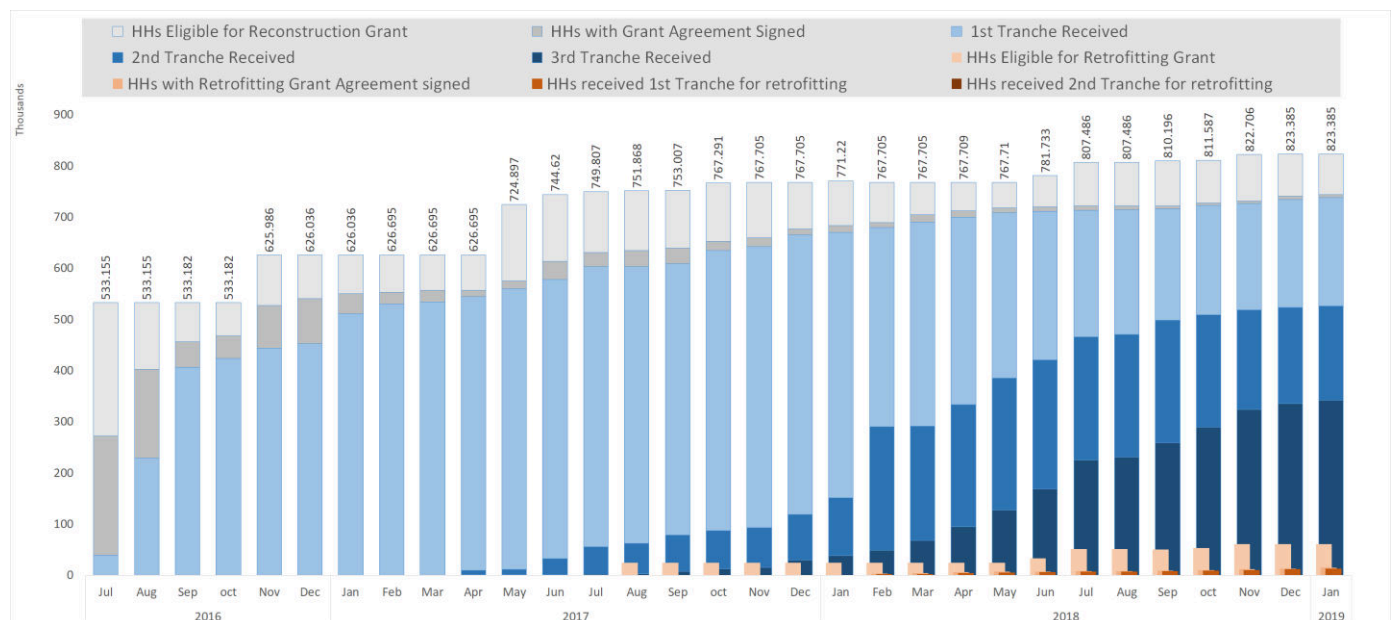
- [Review of Draft Hollow Concrete Block Manual](#): timeframe for providing feedback and suggestions has been extended. Please share your feedback with Kuber Bogati, HRRP National Technical Coordination Officer, techofficer1.national@hrrpnepal.org, by COB, Friday 11 January.
- As of 7 January, the total number of HHs that have returned the first tranche is 71, an increase of 37 since 24 December
- District Level Reconstruction Orientation and Review Workshops, delivered by NRA CLPIUs (Building and GMALI) with support from HRRP, have been completed in 21 districts so far. The NRA has signed an MoU ([Nepali](#), [Unofficial English Translation](#)) with more than 175 municipalities so far.
- Third anniversary of the National Reconstruction Authority marked on 25 December
- Technical case study from Ward No. 5, Kalika Rural Municipality, Rasuwa
- In Sindhupalchok, Build Change is planning to retrofit 50 stone and mud mortar masonry houses and are in the process of selecting the households. Build Change will cover all costs for the retrofitting except for the cost of construction materials which needs to be covered by the households.

UPDATES & REQUESTS

National

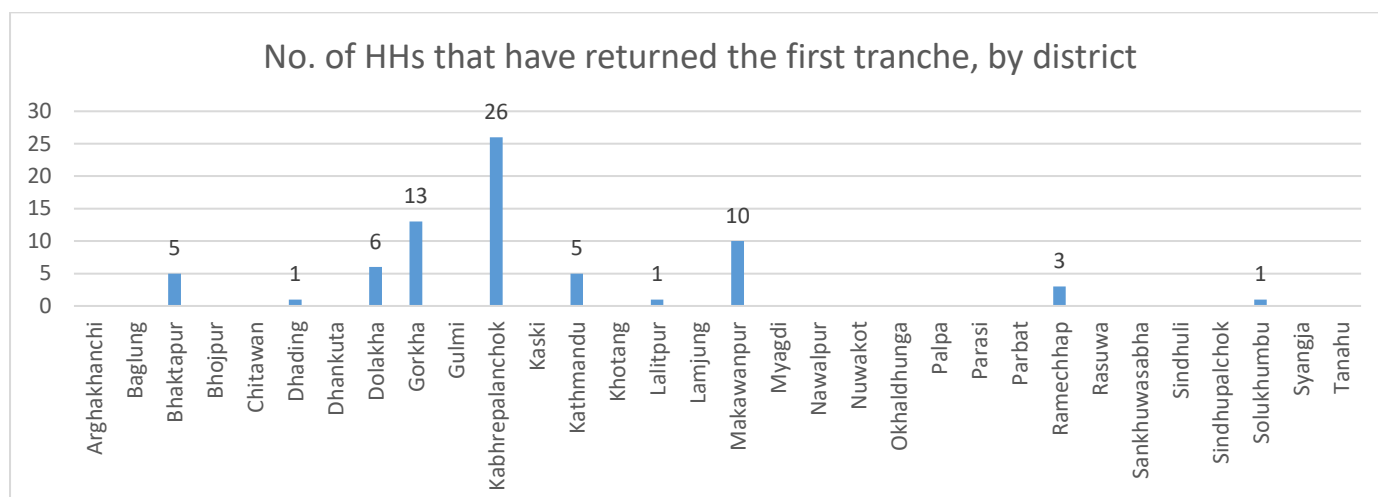
[NRA, CLPIU GMALI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 7 January:](#)

Reconstruction Grant	10 December	24 December	7 January
Total No. Eligible HHs	822,719	823,385	823,385
HHs Enrolled	738,523	740,907	744,228
HHs Received 1 st Tranche	731,441	734,392	738,430
HHs Applied for 2 nd Tranche	557,034	594,354	542,667
HHs Received 2 nd Tranche	521,431	523,889	526,794
Non-compliant at 2 nd Tranche		4,823	4,599
HHs Applied for 3 rd Tranche	369,135	415,664	381,097
HHs Received 3 rd Tranche	331,543	336,263	342,839
Non-compliant at 3 rd Tranche		2,355	2,506
Houses Completed		367,334	347,748
HHs with Completion Certificate		4,750	4,421
Retrofit Grant	10 December	24 December	7 January
Total No. Eligible HHs	60,984	61,591	61,591
HHs Enrolled	12,698	13,591	15,025
HHs Received 1 st Tranche	11,011	11,974	13,689
HHs Received 2 nd Tranche	4	4	4



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMALI CLPIU, and Building CLPIU data from July 2016 to 7 January 2019.

Tracking Return of First Tranche: numbers are based on data collected by HRRP District Coordination Teams (DCTs) through the GMALI DLPIU offices. As of 7 January, the total number of households that have returned the first tranche is 71, an increase of 37 since 24 December. The biggest increases were in Gorkha and Kavre.

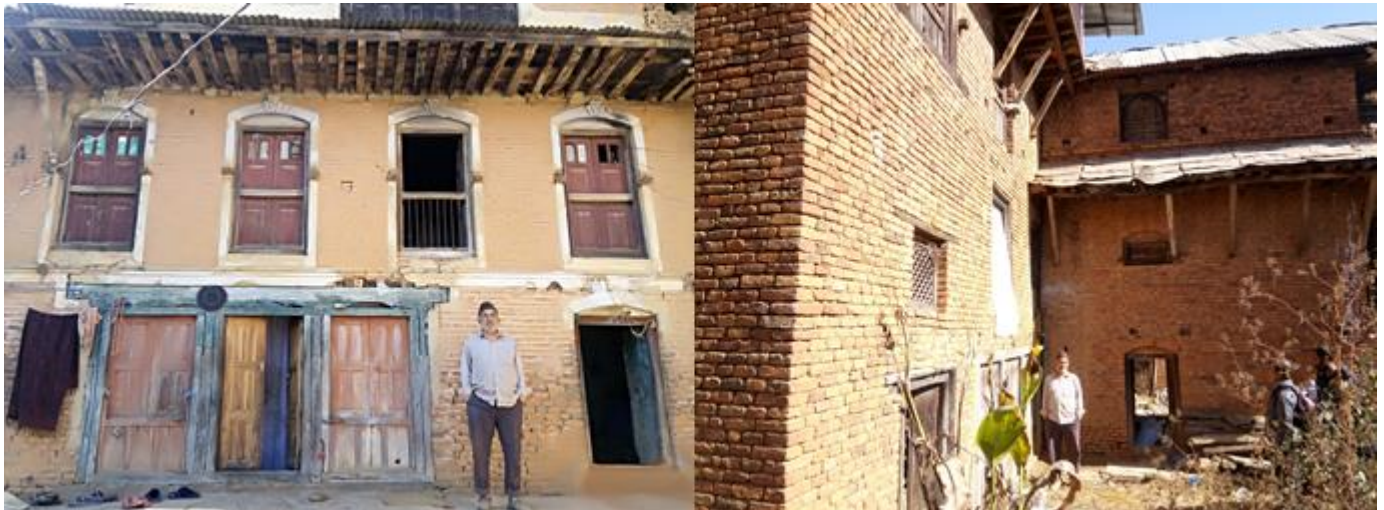


[Mr. Mahendra Raj Rajopadhyaya](#) lives in Tipi Tole, Ward no. 6, Pharping, Dakshinkali Municipality. He is 61 years old and is a local priest. He visits his neighbours to perform traditional Nepali rituals and he also earns some money through agriculture work. He lives with mother (who is 86 years old), wife, and young son who currently works in a bakery shop. Mr. Rajopadhyaya jointly owns 7 ropanies of land in nearby area that is shared in equal portion with his 2 brothers and that is taken care by tenant farmers. Mr. Mahendra's family house constructed in 1952 AD and was damaged by the 2015 earthquake. It is a 2.5 storey, brick and mud mortar masonry house in traditional Newari style. Visible cracks can be seen in the interior parts of his house.

After the earthquake, he and his family built a temporary shelter out of CGI sheets. They received tarpaulin sheets from an NGO and the 15,000 NPRs cash grant provided by the government. When the number and size of aftershocks decreased the family moved back into the damaged house and Mr. Rajopadhyaya signed the PA with the GoN on 19 July 2017. Sometimes if there are aftershocks the family goes back to the temporary shelter, which they still use for storage, etc. Mr. Rajopadhyaya shared that once he received the first tranche of the grant he searched for trained masons to rebuild his house but could not find anyone locally. He also began to realise that demolishing his family home would cost him a lot of money and he would not be able to afford to reconstruct a house that would be big enough to meet their living requirements. He also shared that he has never received information on safer reconstruction, retrofitting options, etc.

Mr. Rajopadhyaya returned the first tranche and his PA card in late December because he has not been able to find well trained masons to reconstruct his house, access to water for construction is challenging, he does not have sufficient money to cover the cost of demolishing the existing house and removing the rubble, he had trouble finding a trained person to prepare building drawings, and he does not have sufficient money to put with the GoN grant of 300,000 NPRs to cover the cost of building a house that meets their needs. He also did not want to face any fines or punishment for missing the deadlines and was worried about the impact on him and his family if they were included on any blacklist forms.

After returning the first tranche and PA card, Mr. Rajopadhyaya and his family continue to live in their earthquake damaged house. He states that he might rebuild his house sometime later, but he does not have any immediate plans. He along with his family members have fears of aftershocks and a possible next earthquake, but he states that "everybody will have to die one day from natural calamities like earthquake, they live in an old brick house like his or in a modern RCC house".



Mr. Rajopadhyaya stands in front of his brick and mud mortar masonry house that was damaged in the 2015 earthquake (left). The rear of the house (right).



Inside Mr. Rajopadhyaya's house where the earthquake damage can be seen in the cracks at the joins of the walls.



The temporary shelter that Mr. Rajopadhyaya and his family built after the earthquake and lived in until moving back into their earthquake damaged house when the aftershocks stopped.

Executive Committee Meeting Decisions: the decisions from NRA Executive Committee meetings are now available on the NRA website (in Nepali). The most recent meeting was held on 25 December and the decisions from this meeting are available [here](#).

Third Anniversary of the Establishment of the NRA, 25 December 2018: during this period the NRA held a number of events at national and district level to mark this milestone. At district level, various meetings and events were held to mark the anniversary. At national level a press conference on reconstruction progress was held, the foundation of the Dharara tower was laid, and a photo exhibition displaying photos of reconstruction work. The NRA's 2018 progress report is available [here](#) (in Nepali).



NRA Press Conference to mark the third anniversary of the authority.



Honorable Prime Minister KP Oli laying the foundation stone of the Dharara tower.

Experience Sharing Session on Rohingya Refugee Response in Bangladesh, 2 January: this session was organised by HRRP to provide a space to share experiences and have discussion on some of the learning from this response and thoughts on the longer-term shelter needs. The session started with various presentations, [Coordination mechanism and shelter sector strategy](#), [Community based approach in emergency response](#), [overview of DRR program and lesson learned](#), [Toward phase-III midterm shelter solution](#), followed by Q&A and open discussion session. Identifying vulnerability criteria and participatory process for targeting and prioritisation, Gender Based Violence, accessible shelters, and protection issues were the major areas discussed during the Q&A.

Consultation meeting with stakeholders on ‘Assessment of Business Development and Livelihood Opportunities for the Earthquake Affected Beneficiaries’, World Bank, 27 December: this consultation was held with stakeholders as part of preparations to launch an assessment which is being carried out as per the request of NRA CEO. The scope of the assessment is to identify the opportunities and impediments for Livelihoods, Enterprise and Employment Development (LEED) in construction and other sectors, to understand the eco-system for LEED support-current strengths and limitations for the current arrangements, to understand the role that NRA should play, and to consider what the viable institutional arrangements might be for that role. The participants in the meeting included representatives from Sakchya Access to Finance, Poverty Alleviation Fund (PAF), Plan International, Helvetas, Scott Wilson, Build Up Nepal, Lutheran World Relief (LWR), HRRP, NSET, and CECI. The assessment is being led by a consultant, Shahnaz Kapadia Rahat, shahnaz@meramaan.org.

Districts & Municipalities

Featured Technical Staff Person, Urusha Shakya: Urusha worked first as an inspection engineer in Kalyanpur VDC in Nuwakot, starting on 26 April 2016. After six months she became the focal person for inspection engineers in Nuwakot and on 17 September 2018 she moved to Kathmandu Building DLPIU where she verifies inspection files submitted by inspection engineers and is focused on Dakshinkali and Kirtipur Municipality.

When Urusha first started in Kalyanpur VDC it was challenging, especially when she had to inform people that their houses were non-compliant and could not be approved. However, she got support from DLPIU technical staffs, the District Support Engineer, and other staff. As she spent more time working there, there was also a message among the HHs and masons that women can be engineers. Another major challenge that Urusha faced in Kalyanpur was language barriers. The communities she was working with are Tamang and she does not understand Tamang and

many people in the community struggled to understand Nepali, especially when Urusha was sharing relatively technical or complex information. Mason trainings were conducted in close coordination with Ward Representatives and the masons became local agents of technical assistance. Initially, the masons were taught using photographs showing compliant construction. Eventually, a trend was set where HHs or masons would come and discuss issues with Urusha if they had any confusion.

Since moving to Kathmandu DLPIU, Urusha shares that she has found many differences in the context. In Kathmandu reconstruction is just starting, but in Nuwakot Urusha felt that they had seen huge progress. Inspections are more complicated in terms of logistics in Kathmandu, with inspection engineers having to return to the same area multiple times. Whereas in Nuwakot many houses were inspected in an area during each visit. However, technically the inspections in Kathmandu are easier because the Kathmandu Municipality building by-laws are very strong and home owners must get a building permit to start construction, whereas in Nuwakot the engineers have to spend a lot of time explaining the building code and minimum requirements to home owners as they are new, and most people are not clear on the requirements. Urusha also shared that in Nuwakot, communities had stronger communication between themselves but in Kathmandu this is not really present. Urusha also shared that in Nuwakot there is a very high demand for RCC houses, but the quality of construction in some cases was very poor leaving the buildings very vulnerable.



A house under construction in Kalyanpur (Bidur NP- ward no 13), Nuwakot.



On the Job masons training in Dupcheshwar, Nuwakot. Urusha found masons training increased engagement with community people and reduced language barriers.



Stone and cement mortar masonry house being built in Gaunkhara, Nuwakot



Urusha (left) and Skishya(right) inspecting a house in Ghyanphedi, Nuwakot.

Technical Case Study, Ward No. 5, Kalika RM, Jibjibe, Rasuwa: the home owner has already received the third tranche of the GoN housing grant and then built the first floor after receiving the third tranche. In order to receive the third tranche, the house had to be analysed by the District Support Engineer (DSE) as the columns in the ground floor are 9"x12" which does not meet the required standards. Altogether there are 6 columns in the house and the walls are 9". The DSE recommended use of light CGI roofing, and construction of an interior partition wall, as the room sizes also did not meet the required standards. After completion of the structure up to the roof band the house was approved for the third tranche. After receiving the third tranche the owner constructed the two room, 4" masonry wall system structure as the first floor, and now the whole structure is more vulnerable. The distribution of construction completion certificates has begun in this area, but the home owner will not be able to receive the certificate without making significant corrections to the structure.



The non-compliant structure.

Seven Day Training of Trainers (ToT) on Earthquake Resistant Building Construction, Dhulikhel, Kavre, 7 January:

the training is for newly recruited NRA engineers and started today. There are 34 engineers taking part in the training, of whom 10 are women. The engineers will be deployed in Kavre and Bhaktapur after completing the training. The event was organised by Building CLPIU with technical support from HRRP and NSET. This is the sixth training in this series. The topics covered include earthquake basics, earthquake resistant design and construction philosophy, Nepal National Building Code, inspection process of reconstructed building typologies, retrofitting etc.

District Level Reconstruction Orientation and Review Workshops, NRA CLPIUs (Building and GMALI): these workshops have been completed in 21 districts so far and will be carried out in the remaining districts in the coming weeks. The major outcomes of the workshops are NRA signing an MoU ([Nepali](#), [Unofficial English Translation](#)) with each of the municipalities and the municipalities preparing draft municipal reconstruction action plans.

- **Kavre, 25 & 26 November:** MoU signed with all 13 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and municipal profiles ([English](#), [Nepali](#)), presentation slides are available [here](#)
- **Dhankuta, 7 & 8 December:** MoU signed with 5 municipalities (2 were not present and will sign later), [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Solukhumbu, 7 & 8 December:** MoU signed with all 7 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Sankhuwasabha, 9 & 10 December:** MoU signed with 9 municipalities (Bhotkhola Rural Municipality will sign later), [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Okhaldhunga, 9 & 10 December:** MoU signed with all 8 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Lalitpur, 9 & 10 December:** MoU signed with 5 municipalities (Lalitpur Metropolitan City will sign later), [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [municipal profiles](#)
- **Bhaktapur, 11 & 12 December:** MoU signed with all 4 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#), presentation slides are available [here](#)
- **Bhojpur, 11 & 12 December:** MoU signed with 4 municipalities, 5 remaining (Arun, Bhojpur, Hatuwagadhi, Salpasilicho, and Shadananda) [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#).
- **Khotang, 11 & 12 December:** MoU signed with all 10 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Kathmandu, 18 & 19 December:** MoU signed with 5 municipalities, 6 remaining (Dakshinkali, Gorkarneshor, Kageshori Manahara, Kathmandu, Kirtipur, and Nagarjun) [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#), presentation slides are available [here](#)
- **Dolakha, 21 & 22 December:** MoU signed with 8 municipalities, (Tamakoshi RM not present, will sign later) [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Makwanpur, 21 & 22 December:** MoU signed with all 10 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Sindhupalchok, 21 & 22 December:** MoU signed with 11 municipalities, 1 remaining (Panchpokhari Thangpal) [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Palpa, 22 & 23 December:** MoU signed with all 9 municipalities, 1 remaining (Tansen Municipality) [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Gorkha, 23 & 24 December:** MoU signed with all 11 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Gulmi, 24 & 25 December:** MoU signed with all 12 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Sindhuli, 25 & 26 December:** MoU signed with all 9 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)

- **Dhading, 25 & 26 December:** MoU signed with all 13 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Arghakhanchi, 26 & 27 December:** MoU signed with all 6 municipalities, [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Ramechhap, 27 & 28 December:** MoU signed with 7 municipalities, 1 remaining (Doramba RM was not present) [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)
- **Nuwakot, 30 & 31 December:** MoU signed with 10 municipalities, 2 remaining (Shivapuri and Suryagadhi RMs were not present) [draft reconstruction action plans](#) and [sample municipal profiles](#)

Videos from the events are available on YouTube. Some recently uploaded videos include interviews with:

- [Shambhu Kumar Thapa, Chairperson, Tripurasundari Rural municipality, Dhading](#)
- [Rakesh Dev, DLPIU Focal Engineer, Sindhupalchowk](#)
- [Yubak Shrestha, Focal Engineer, DLPIU Building, Gorkha](#)
- [Bishnu Bhatta, Chairperson, Barpak Sulikot Rural Municipality, Gorkha](#)
- [Raju Gurung, Chairperson, Siranchowk Rural Municipality, Gorkha](#)
- [Tanka Bahadur Moktan, Chairperson, Kailash Rural Municipality, Makwanpur](#)

For further information please contact Minar Thapa Magar, HRRP National Coordination Officer, minar@hrrpnepal.org.

HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 21 Dec 2018 – 3 Jan 2019: during this period district coordination meetings took place in Dolakha (26 December), Nuwakot (27 December), Rasuwa (27 December), and Sindhupalchok (31 December). Municipal level meetings took place in Kalinchowk Rural Municipality, Dolakha (23 December), Bigu Rural Municipality, Dolakha (23 and 24 December), Balephi Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok (26 December), Dudhouli Rural Municipality, Sindhui (1 January), Gokarneshwor Municipality, Kathmandu (2 January), and Dakshinkali Municipality, Kathmandu (3 January). Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In **Dolakha**, GMALI strongly urged all Partner Organisations (POs) to closely coordinate with the municipal and ward level government for any activities to be carried out in their areas. DLPIU Building discussed issues that came from a field visit to non-compliant houses in Bigu Rural Municipality. Ward representatives in Bigu RM were all positive on conducting a final inspection of the houses and plan for the distribution of completion certificates.
- In **Nuwakot**, HRRP provided an update on reconstruction status by municipality, grant distribution status by Partner Organisations (POs), and trainings conducted by POs. NSET through its awareness and capacity enhancement activities has been able to orient 28,403 beneficiaries through 1,234 events in 9 VDCs and trained 1,573 and 1,345 masons under 7 days and 50 days training respectively. Practical Action working in supply chain and technology transfer to the rural communities shared the use of CSEB and stone cutting as an alternative construction material in rural areas. OXFAM has completed relocation of 24 HHs from Urleni. Altogether, OXFAM is supporting relocation of 240 HHs from different parts of the district but due to some issues in duplication some of these HHs have already received the second and third tranches and as a result relocation has been a challenge.
- In **Rasuwa**, the meeting was held on the third anniversary of the establishment of the NRA. GMALI, Building, and Education DLPIUs shared reconstruction progress, lessons learnt, and challenges in the district. HRRP shared some of the major activities carried out during the past three years such as formation of NRA, guidelines and policy documents developed, and POs support during relief phase and for recovery and reconstruction. It was also highlighted that Rasuwa has more than 1,000 HHs displaced but due to limited safe land available, it has been a challenge for HHs to relocate.
- In **Sindhupalchok**, DLPIU Building highlighted the need of CS entry by field engineers since 27,500 i.e. only 2% of the required entries have been done which is a huge gap. This has implications in releasing the grant

by the donors, so field engineers were requested to put this as a priority task. Build Change is planning to retrofit 50 stone and mud mortar masonry houses and are in the process of selecting the households. Build Change will cover all costs for the retrofitting except for the cost of construction materials which needs to be covered by the households. Coordination among POs, rural municipality engineers, and District Support Engineers (DSEs), was seen as necessary to avoid conflict and misunderstanding amongst households and concerned stakeholders in terms of house design, inspection, and tranche approval process.

- In **Ward 9, Kalinchowk RM, Dolakha**, the main issues related to non-compliant construction were absence of top rounding beam, flexible floor, and 4-inch-thick wall in between columns in case of houses with columns 12 x 12. The ward representatives were positive on conducting a final inspection of houses that have received third tranche and completed up to the roof level for the distribution of completion certificates. Ward office also agreed to apply correction measures as suggested by DSE, however, if there is any confusion, DSE can also be present in the field for any direction or support.
- In **Ward 8, Bigu RM, Dolakha**, some of the major non-compliant issues include houses built without DPC, improper placement of vertical and horizontal bands, and discontinuous lintel/roof bands. One of the issues was irregular presence of technical persons which has caused delay in inspection, forwarding the files, and applying correction to the houses. DLPIU requested the ward office to keep attendance of technical staffs which will help to verify their presence in the field. The ward representatives were positive on conducting a final inspection of houses that have received third tranche and completed up to the roof level for the distribution of completion certificates. Ward office also agreed to apply correction measures as suggested by DSE, however, if there is any confusion, DSE can also be present in the field for any direction or support.
- In **Ward 7, Bigu RM, Dolakha**, the main concern raised was that delays in forwarding the tranche to the households are causing difficulties for people as they have no way to know if the tranche payment has been deposited in their account or not. The ward office suggested that if they were able to access information on tranche status then they could share this with households and then they wouldn't have to travel to the district headquarters (which is costly and time consuming) just to find out if the tranche payment is in their account or not. The major non-compliance issue in the ward is with stone and mud mortar masonry structures where an attic or additional storeys have been added. The ward office reported that they are satisfied with the presence and support of technical staff. They were also positive on conducting a final inspection of houses that have received third tranche and completed up to the roof level for the distribution of completion certificates. Ward office also agreed to apply correction measures as suggested/directed by DSE.
- In **Ward 6, Bigu RM, Dolakha**, reconstruction is moving at good pace with 80% houses completed. There are about 65 HHs that were severely damaged by 2015 earthquake but have not been included in as eligible for the housing reconstruction grant. It was recommended that the ward office keep records of these HHs and recommend them when NRA conducts resurvey and verification. The major non-compliance issue in the ward is with stone and mud mortar masonry structures where an attic or additional storeys have been added. The ward office was found to be positive on suggestion made to carry out the final inspection of houses that have received third tranche and completed up to roof level for the distribution of completion certificates. Ward office also agreed to do the correction of the non-compliant houses as suggested/directed by DSE.
- In **Balephi RM, Sindhupalchok**, reconstruction is at good pace due to the availability of local materials such as stone aggregate, mud, timber, and sand. Availability of masons and technical assistance from JICA has also contributed in high reconstruction in the area. However, water scarcity, lack of awareness at local level, slow process in approval of timber by District Forest Office, insufficient door to door technical assistance, and irregular presence of engineers are the challenges in some areas delaying reconstruction. Some of the non-compliant cases in the areas are stepping houses, slab common cast, and common column. There are also high expectations from local representatives and households in terms of support

they will receive from POs which is causing challenges in reconstruction. There are a few households living in their old houses after some repair and maintenance but have constructed one room house just for the sake of receiving the grant.

- In **Ward 3, Gokarneshwor Municipality, Kathmandu**, it was reported that due to the issues related to multiple owners and duplication in PA number, there has been delay in reconstruction. Similarly, households holding small land parcels have not started reconstruction as it is not suitable to construct RCC houses on such small land. Another issue in the area is with tenant farmers who have been living in the area for a long time and the land owners (Mohi/Talshing). However, the Municipality and Ward representatives have facilitated the process of reconstruction for tenant farmers in such lands, decision includes: (1) If the tenant farmers beneficiary intends to rebuild house on the land owned by landowners then public inquiry deed process will be adopted by Ward office to support tenant farmers in registering the land & providing building permit. There is no need of taking consent from the landowners. (2) If the tenant farmers beneficiary intends to rebuild house on other land than of landowners' property then, written consent need to be provided by landowners to beneficiaries. But beneficiaries (tenant farmers) have not been able to get in contact with the Talsing (land owners) due to reasons such as land property were found to be neglected by landowners' family, death of main landowner, and landowners & their family members not in contact with tenant farmers. Ward office has coordinated with the Municipality in being flexible for the Municipal bylaws but have not been successful.
- In **Ward 6, Dakshinkali Municipality, Kathmandu**, major concerns in delay in reconstruction are small parcel of lands, households living in unregistered land with no legal documents, eccentric footing, and issues with multiple owners. Some of the households in the area have already reconstructed their house but do not have a building permit, thus, they have not received the second tranche. There are households who have received the first tranche and not started reconstruction, the Ward office assured to prepare a list of those households, track them to find the reasons for not starting, and encourage the ones to return the first tranche if not intending to start reconstruction. In addition, Ward office plans to collect the details of households who are not eligible for the reconstruction grant but whose houses are exposed to damage due to demolition of earthquake affected houses, a case of eccentric footing. Ward office was also briefed on the review workshop conducted by NRA, MoU done between local level and NRA where responsibilities are handed over to the local government.
- In **Wards 7 & 8 Dudhouli RM, Sindhuli**, main issue was regarding 'Elani' land (government land), where 80% of beneficiaries in ward 7 reside, such that only 30% have started reconstruction. There was delay in getting the tranche by the households due to delay in inspection caused by delay in training if light timber manual. It was reported that due to delay in grievance results, households are not sure of starting reconstruction or go for retrofitting. There has been delay in inspection due to the unavailability of hybrid structure inspection forms and ward office lacked information on reconstruction.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Weekly District Report, 21 Dec 2018 – 3 Jan 2019



Ward No. 5, Netrawati Rural Municipality, Dhading: two storey, load bearing, hybrid structure with stone and mud mortar masonry ground floor and steel frame for the first floor. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Weekly District Report, 21 Dec 2018 – 3 Jan 2019



Ward No. 7, Bigu Rural Municipality, Dolakha: hybrid structure with dry stone masonry ground floor and light timber frame first floor. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. The home owner added the light structure above ground floor after receiving the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Gorkha, Weekly District Report, 21 Dec 2018 – 3 Jan 2019



Ward No. 8, Sahid Lakhan Rural Municipality, Gorkha: RCC demo house under construction by participants of 50 days OJT. Toilet using plastic bottles is also under construction. The house is intended to be used as ward office. The house is constructed with support from SDSC/CRS.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Valley, Weekly District Report, 21 Dec 2018 – 3 Jan 2019



Ward No. 3, Gokarneshwor Municipality, Kathmandu: two storey, brick and mud mortar masonry house. The home owner is a full reconstruction beneficiary and has received first tranche of GoN housing grant. He repaired his house using steel post to form frame structure in the second storey of the house so, he wants to switch to retrofit beneficiary. However, the house cannot be considered for retrofitting. The home owner has another house and he intends to return 50,000 NPRs if this house cannot be retrofitted.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur, Weekly District Report, 21 Dec 2018 – 3 Jan 2019



Ward No. 4, Bagmati Rural Municipality, Makwanpur: two room, brick and cement mortar masonry house with flexible roof. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. The house does not have gable band for the heavy construction materials used so, it does not qualify for the completion certificate.

HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Weekly District Report, 21 Dec 2018 – 3 Jan 2019



Ward No. 1, Panchakanya Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: a single room CSEB house under construction. The home owner is 83 years old and is living in his damaged house. The house is constructed with support from RSDC.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhuli, Weekly District Report, 21 Dec 2018 – 3 Jan 2019



Ward No. 9, Kamalamai Municipality, Sindhuli: a timber frame structure, ground floor is open (bare frame structure) and the first floor is light timber plank structure. The home owner has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

Requests for Partner Support

Review of Draft Hollow Concrete Block Manual: this draft manual has been developed by a technical working group under the NRA technical committee. The timeframe for providing feedback and suggestions has been extended by one week. Please share your feedback with Kuber Bogati, HRRP National Technical Coordination Officer, techofficer1.national@hrrpnepal.org, by COB, Friday 11 January.

'Epicentre to Aftermath: Political, social and cultural impacts of earthquakes in South Asia', 11 and 12 January, London: this two-day conference is focused on the political and cultural impacts of earthquakes in South Asia and is hosted by the SOAS South Asia Institute as part of [SOAS's SWAY project](#). Many of the papers presented at this conference will focus on the 2015 Nepal earthquake. The keynote speaker for the conference is Dr. Sara Shneiderman whose talk is entitled 'Restructuring Life: political, social, and material transformation in post - conflict, post-disaster Nepal' and will be delivered at SOAS on the evening of Friday 11 January. If you are interested to attend, please register [here](#).

Earthquake Safety Day 2019, 16 January: the theme for this year's ESD is "Committed Governments at all levels to ensure Citizen's Right to Safety from Disasters". The main event is being planned in Lalitpur district, which may include a rally, address by Prime Minister, and later followed up by panel discussion which is scheduled to be organised at Staff College-Jawalakhel. The rally will be organised at 4 different places and will be merged at the staff college. These components are in a planning stage and various discussions and meetings are ongoing, but not finalised yet. Any partners planning events or activities to mark ESD are requested to share details with Sufi Mohammad Faiz, HRRP District Management Team Coordinator, dmt.coord@hrrpnepal.org.

Market Development of Clean Cookstoves in Nepal, Project Sharing Session by Practical Action, 18 January, 1:30PM, HRRP Office Jwagal: in this session Practical Action will share about their market development approach to promoting improved cook stoves (hood-stove and portable cook stoves) with earthquake affected households

and communities. In Nepal, every year more than 18,000 people mainly women and children die prematurely due to smoke generated from the use of inefficient stoves. This event will be an opportunity to learn about options for improved cookstoves and to provide constructive suggestions on Practical Action's project implementation approach and strategy. Please contact Rupa Panday (meal@hrrpnepal.org) or Min Bikram Malla (MinBikram.Malla@practicalaction.org.np) if you have any questions regarding the event.

International Recovery Forum 2019, 18 January, Kobe, Japan: this forum will draw upon the insights and experiences of governments, the private sector, and international and civil society organisations to address questions about the 'Build Back Better' approach. In particular, how the benefits of BBB can be realised, who should benefit, and how to ensure no one is left behind. The forum includes keynote speakers and two panel discussions where the first panel will focus on strategic questions to guide how governments and communities build back better and achieve the greatest possible benefits and the second panel will focus on inclusive approaches to Building Back Better - to improve participation, access, and assistance to vulnerable groups and attain more equitable sharing of the benefits of 'Build Back Better'.

DOCUMENTS & PRODUCTS

Partners

Milijuli Nepali, Episode 1144: this episode is an on-location programme from Bandipur, Tanahu. The presenter, Prakash Sundas, is guided by Ishwor Gopal Pradhan, a resident of Bandipur, on a local tour. As they walk through the ancient city, Ishwor Gopal explains about the history of Bandipur and the ways in which Bandipur residents have preserved the traditional cultural heritage. The visit Kalpana Piya, who shares how the people clean their own front and backyards as a part their culture and keeping clean helps them to attract visitors. The second conversation is with a married couple, Shanta and Bishnu Shrestha. Bishnu Shrestha shares that she did not know about retrofitting and says she will consult with an engineer for further information to retrofit their house. The third story is of Ganesh Kumari Pradhan, who knits and sells woolen items, which keeps an old tradition alive. Ishwor says that the traditional houses were built using trained masons brought from Bhaktapur and Kritipur. He shares that the residents in Bandipur cannot demolish a house but can repair or retrofit the houses as they are an important aspect of their cultural heritage. He says that every house has a tie beam which has prevented the houses from being completely destroyed.

Baliyo Ghar TV, Episode 125:

this episode focuses on the challenges and gaps in reconstructing Nepal and their possible solutions. The programme includes stories from earthquake affected areas and an interview with Mr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha, NRA Executive Committee Member.



Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment in Disaster Recovery, GFDRR Disaster Recovery Guidance Series:

this guidance note is structured around three key areas: 1. Identifying and Prioritising Gender-Specific Recovery Needs, 2. Protecting Women and Men from Physical and Psychosocial Harm, and 3. Planning for Gender-Responsive Recovery in the Disaster Recovery Framework and Empowering Women for Sustainable and Resilient Recovery. The final section of the paper provides a long-term outlook on strengthening gender responsive recovery systems. This note is accompanied by an extensive reading list that is available on the [Global Facility for Disaster Reduction and Recovery's \(GFDRR\) Recovery Hub website](#), under the [Gender section](#).

Transport Sector Recovery: Opportunities to Build Resilience, GFDRR Disaster Recovery Guidance Series: this guidance note is intended to provide action-oriented guidance to government officials facing post-disaster recovery challenges related to the transport sector. The paper offers best practices, case studies, and tools that can help transport officials identify entry points for building resilience and building back better, as well as guidance for how to undertake a more effective and better-coordinated recovery of the transport sector. This note is accompanied by an extensive reading list that is available on the [Global Facility for Disaster Reduction and Recovery's \(GFDRR\) Recovery Hub website](#), under the [Transport section](#).

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